

▼ GLASSHOUSE

BHAGWAT'S BROAD HINT

RSS *sarsanghchalak* Mohan Bhagwat may have gently lobbed a saffron-tinted grenade among the Sangh ranks. "Those in public life should step aside after 75," said the Sangh supremo, who himself hits the mark this September. Sangh-watchers are already reading deep into the tea leaves. Was it self-reflection or a veiled dig at others overstaying their political welcome? Only two previous RSS chiefs—M.D. Deoras and K.S. Sudarshan—have voluntarily stepped down, both due to health issues. Bhagwat, on the other hand, is fighting fit. If he does exit on schedule, it would be a first in Nagpur's no-retiring-till-dotage tradition. More importantly, it will make matters a little shifty for Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who also hits the same age milestone in September. Nagpur is vague. Delhi is silent. But the whispers are getting louder.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ INTO THE WILD

SPIRITUAL COEXISTENCE

Odisha's new CM **Mohan Charan Majhi** has embarked on a new divine mission: building a temple beside a wildlife sanctuary. In a heartfelt letter, the BJP leader has urged Union environment minister Bhupender Yadav to trim the eco-sensitive zone (ESZ) around the Balukhand Wildlife Sanctuary from a protective 500 metres to a token 50. The reason? A proposed Shree Swaminarayan temple destined to grace the Puri-Konark Marine Drive happens to fall squarely within the ESZ. The CM has promised that the temple will tread lightly, and cause 'minimal disturbance' to wildlife. Meanwhile, the coastal sanctuary, still recovering from the devastation of Cyclone Fani, remains blissfully unaware that it may soon have a spiritual neighbour.

